

FEDERAL BOARD OF INTERMEDIATE AND SECONDARY EDUCATION, ISLAMABAD

Annual Examination 2026
Biology — Class IX | Paper: SSC-I
Syllabus: Chapter 7 — Metabolism
ANSWER KEY (Version 1)

SECTION A — Multiple Choice Questions (12 × 1 = 12 Marks)

Q1. Sum of all chemical reactions in a living cell: C — Metabolism 1 mark

Metabolism is the sum of all chemical reactions in each cell for maintenance of life. **Catabolism** and **anabolism** are the two types of metabolism, not metabolism itself. Enzymology is the study of enzymes.

Q2. Enzymes are produced by: B — Living cells 1 mark

Enzymes are **biologically active globular proteins made by living cells**. Each cell synthesises its own enzymes, determined by active genes. They cannot be produced by dead cells or inorganic ions.

Q3. Part of enzyme where substrate binds: C — Active site 1 mark

The **active site** is the charge-bearing cavity on the enzyme's surface where substrate binds and reaction occurs. The **allosteric site** is where non-competitive inhibitors bind — not the reactive site.

Q4. Enzyme loses function at high temperature because it is: B — Denatured 1 mark

At very high temperatures, enzyme atoms vibrate vigorously — the globular structure and active site are destroyed (**denatured**). At low temperature, inactivity is reversible; denaturation at high temperature is permanent.

Q5. Competitive inhibitor binds to the: C — Active site 1 mark

In **competitive inhibition**, the inhibitor resembles the substrate in shape and occupies the **active site**, blocking the substrate. The allosteric site is the target for non-competitive inhibitors only.

Q6. ATP is energy currency because it: B — Stores and releases energy 1 mark

ATP is an **energy-rich compound** that stores energy (in high-energy phosphate bonds) and releases it on demand when hydrolysed — used like money across all cell functions.

Q7. Third component of ATP alongside adenine and ribose: B — Three phosphate groups 1 mark

ATP = Adenosine + **Three phosphate groups** (triphosphate chain). The covalent bonds between phosphate groups are **high-energy bonds** that store the usable energy.

Q8. Oxygen is released as by-product through: B — Photolysis of water 1 mark

In light-dependent reactions, water splits into O, H⁺ and electrons — this is **photolysis of water**. Oxygen exits through stomata. Calvin cycle and Krebs cycle do not produce oxygen.

Q9. Calvin cycle takes place in the: C — Stroma of chloroplast 1 mark

Light-independent (dark) reactions take place in the **stroma of chloroplast**. Light-dependent reactions are in thylakoid membranes. Glycolysis is in cytoplasm; Krebs cycle is in mitochondria.

Q10. Net ATP gain from glycolysis: C — 2 ATP 1 mark

Glycolysis produces 4 ATP gross but consumes 2, giving a **net gain of 2 ATP** per glucose molecule. The 36 ATP figure is the total from complete aerobic respiration, not glycolysis alone.

Q11. Alcoholic fermentation (yeast) products: C — Carbon dioxide 1 mark

In yeast: Pyruvic acid → **Ethyl Alcohol + Carbon dioxide**. This is used in wine making and bread baking. Lactic acid is the product in muscle cells, not in yeast.

Q12. Final electron acceptor in ETC: C — Oxygen 1 mark

In the electron transport chain, **oxygen** is the final electron acceptor. It combines with H⁺ ions to produce water. Without oxygen, the ETC stops — this is why aerobic respiration requires oxygen.

SECTION B — Short Questions Answers (3 marks each)

2(i) Metabolism / catabolism / anabolism with examples 3 marks

Metabolism 1 mark: Sum of all chemical reactions in each cell of living organisms for maintenance and sustainability of life.

Catabolism 1 mark: Breaks down complex molecules into simpler ones, releasing energy. Example: Cellular respiration — glucose → CO₂ + H₂O + energy.

Anabolism 1 mark: Builds complex molecules from simpler ones, using energy. Example: Photosynthesis — CO₂ + H₂O → glucose.

OR

Why enzymes are biological catalysts; two characteristics 3 marks

Enzymes are **biological catalysts** 1 mark: made by living cells; speed up reactions without being consumed or permanently changed.

Characteristic 1 1 mark: **Increase rate of reaction** — millions of times faster than non-enzymatic reactions; lower activation energy.

Characteristic 2 1 mark: **Required in small quantity** — enzyme structure regains original shape after reaction; one enzyme catalyses a huge amount of substrate repeatedly.

2(ii) Three types of cofactors with examples 3 marks

Activators 1 mark: Detachable inorganic ions. Example: Cl⁻ ions increase salivary amylase activity; Zn²⁺, Fe²⁺, Cu²⁺.

Prosthetic groups 1 mark: Organic molecules tightly and permanently attached to enzyme. Examples: FAD (Flavin Adenine Dinucleotide), Haem group.

Coenzymes 1 mark: Detachable organic molecules. Examples: NAD (nicotinamide adenine dinucleotide), Coenzyme A, Vitamins A and C.

OR

Enzymes are specific — explanation with example 3 marks

Specificity 1 mark: Each enzyme catalyses only one type of reaction and will not act on a different substrate.

Reason 1 mark: The **active site** has a unique shape fitting only one specific substrate — like a lock fits only one key.

Example 1 mark: **Amylase** acts only on starch (not proteins or fats). **Pepsin** digests only proteins in the stomach.

2(iii) Mechanism of enzyme action: ES and EP complex 3 marks

Step 1 1 mark: Specific substrate binds to the **active site** → forms **Enzyme-Substrate (ES) complex**.

Step 2 1 mark: Enzyme catalyses the reaction, converting substrate to product → forms **Enzyme-Product (EP) complex**.

Step 3 1 mark: EP complex breaks up; products released; **enzyme is unchanged** and available again for the next reaction.

OR

Energy of activation; how enzymes lower it 3 marks

Activation energy 1 mark: Minimum extra energy required to activate molecules to start a chemical reaction.

How enzymes lower it 1 mark: By changing the shape and charge of the substrate at the active site, or providing an entirely different reaction mechanism.

Effect 1 mark: Reactions can proceed at **body temperature** (37°C) without requiring extreme heat or harsh conditions.

2(iv) Effect of temperature on enzyme activity 3 marks

Optimum temperature 1 mark: Each enzyme works best at a specific optimum temperature. For human enzymes: 36–38°C. Rate increases with temperature up to this point.

Very high temperature 1 mark: Enzyme atoms vibrate vigorously → globular structure and active site damaged → **denaturation** (permanent loss of activity).

Very low temperature 1 mark: Insufficient activation energy → enzyme becomes **inactive** (reversible — activity resumes when temperature is restored).

OR

pH effect on enzyme activity; optimum pH for pepsin and trypsin 3 marks

Optimum pH 1 mark: Each enzyme performs best at specific pH. Change in pH affects ionisation of amino acids at the active site. Slight deviation reduces reaction rate; extreme pH denatures enzyme.

Pepsin 1 mark: Optimum pH **2.00** (acidic). Works in stomach; pH maintained by HCl.

Trypsin 1 mark: Optimum pH **8.00** (alkaline). Works in small intestine. Both are protein-digesting enzymes.

2(v) Competitive vs non-competitive inhibition 3 marks

Feature	Competitive	Non-competitive
Binding site	Active site 1 mark	Allosteric site 1 mark
Shape similarity to substrate	Yes — resembles substrate	No
Reversibility 1 mark	Reversible with excess substrate	Irreversible; active site deformed

OR**Allosteric site; how non-competitive inhibitor damages active site** 3 marks**Allosteric site** 1 mark: A point on the enzyme surface other than the active site where non-competitive inhibitors attach.**Mechanism** 1 mark: Inhibitor binding alters the **globular shape** of the enzyme → deforms and damages the active site.**Result** 1 mark: Substrate **cannot bind** to the damaged active site; no ES complex forms; reaction stops.**2(vi) Structure of ATP molecule; three components** 3 marks**Adenine** 1 mark: Double-ringed nitrogen base. Adenine + Ribose = Adenosine.**Ribose sugar** 1 mark: Five-carbon (pentose) sugar.**Three phosphate groups** 1 mark: (PO₄) linked in a triphosphate chain. Bonds between phosphate groups are **high-energy bonds** (wavy lines) — energy stored here is used by cells for all life processes.**OR****ATP-ADP cycle; energy storage and release** 3 marks**Energy storage** 1 mark: ADP + inorganic phosphate (P_i) combine by **condensation** to reform ATP. Energy from catabolism (or light in plants) drives this — stored in phosphate bond.**Energy release** 1 mark: ATP is **hydrolysed** — third phosphate separates → releases energy + ADP + P_i.**Significance** 1 mark: Energy available on demand for movement, active transport, growth, nerve impulse, gland secretion — without wasteful overproduction.**2(vii) Photosynthesis equation; raw materials and products** 3 marks**Raw materials** 1 mark: CO₂ (from air via stomata) and H₂O (absorbed by roots). Chlorophyll captures light energy.**Products** 1 mark: **Glucose** (used for energy and building materials) and **Oxygen** (by-product released through stomata).**Conditions** 1 mark: **Light energy** and **chlorophyll** are essential. Photosynthesis occurs in plants, algae, and cyanobacteria.**OR****Three limiting factors of photosynthesis** 3 marks**Light intensity** 1 mark: More light intensity and longer duration increase photosynthesis rate by providing more energy for light reactions.**CO₂ concentration** 1 mark: CO₂ is raw material (substrate) for the photosynthetic reaction. More CO₂ increases rate — but only up to a specific limit.**Temperature** 1 mark: Optimum temperature for photosynthesis is 25°C. Temperature below or above the optimum decreases rate by affecting enzyme activity.**2(viii) Light-dependent reactions: location and products** 3 marks**Definition** 1 mark: Reactions that require light energy directly; they depend on Photosystems I and II to absorb light and begin photosynthesis.**Location** 1 mark: **Thylakoid membranes** (grana) of chloroplasts, where photosynthetic pigments are arranged into photosystems.**Products** 1 mark: **ATP**, **NADPH**, and **Oxygen** (from photolysis of water). ATP and NADPH power the Calvin cycle.**OR****Photolysis of water; its role in light-dependent reactions** 3 marks**Photolysis** 1 mark: Water molecule splits into oxygen atoms, 2H⁺ ions and 2 electrons under light energy absorbed by Photosystem II.**Role 1** 1 mark: Electrons released by photolysis **replace electrons lost** from the excited chlorophyll of Photosystem II — maintaining the reaction.**Role 2** 1 mark: Oxygen atoms are released as **O₂** through stomata (source of atmospheric oxygen); H⁺ ions reduce NADP⁺ to NADPH.

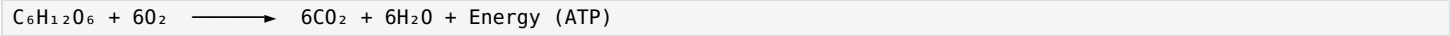
2(ix) Four stages of aerobic respiration in order 3 marks

1. GLYCOLYSIS (Cytoplasm): Glucose → 2 Pyruvic Acid + 2 ATP + 2 NADH
2. FORMATION OF ACETYL CoA (Mitochondria): 2 Pyruvic Acid → 2 Acetyl CoA + 2CO₂ + 2 NADH
3. KREBS CYCLE (Mitochondrial matrix): 2 Acetyl CoA → 4CO₂ + 2 ATP + 6 NADH + 2 FADH₂
4. ELECTRON TRANSPORT CHAIN (Inner mitochondrial membrane): NADH + FADH₂ → 32 ATP + H₂O

1 mark four stages named correctly; 1 mark locations; 1 mark products at each stage.

OR

Aerobic respiration equation; ATP yield per glucose 3 marks



ATP yield 1 mark: Complete aerobic respiration yields **36 ATP** per glucose (2 glycolysis + 2 Krebs + 32 ETC).

Comparison 1 mark: Aerobic = 36 ATP vs anaerobic = 2 ATP — aerobic is 18 times more efficient.

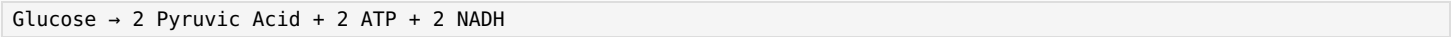
Requirement 1 mark: Requires **oxygen** as final electron acceptor; without O₂, only glycolysis + fermentation occurs.

2(x) Glycolysis: definition, location, products 3 marks

Definition 1 mark: First stage of cellular respiration — one glucose (6C) broken down into two molecules of **pyruvic acid** (3C each).

Location 1 mark: **Cytoplasm** of the cell, outside mitochondria. Common to both aerobic and anaerobic respiration.

Products 1 mark: 2 pyruvic acid + **2 ATP** (net) + 2 NADH.

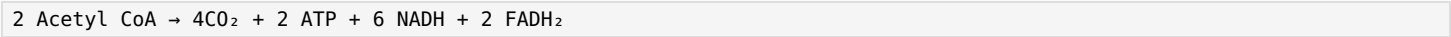


OR

Role of Krebs cycle; products formed 3 marks

Role 1 mark: Cyclic process in **mitochondrial matrix**; acetyl CoA is fully oxidised; energy extracted as electron carriers (NADH, FADH₂) that feed the ETC.

Products 1 mark: **4CO₂ + 2 ATP + 6 NADH + 2 FADH₂** per glucose.



Significance 1 mark: NADH and FADH₂ carry electrons to ETC where most ATP is produced; CO₂ released as waste.

2(xi) Alcoholic vs lactic acid fermentation 3 marks

Feature	Alcoholic Fermentation	Lactic Acid Fermentation
Organism	Yeast, some bacteria	Muscle cells; lactic acid bacteria
Products 1 mark	Ethyl alcohol + CO ₂	Lactic acid only
Equation 1 mark	Pyruvic acid → Ethyl Alcohol + CO ₂	Pyruvic acid → Lactic Acid
Example 1 mark	Wine making; bread baking	Yogurt/cheese; muscle fatigue in exercise

OR

Four reasons anaerobic respiration is important 3 marks

1. 1 mark Early Earth had no free oxygen; earliest organisms produced energy by **anaerobic respiration** — an evolutionary necessity.
2. 1 mark Bacteria use anaerobic respiration for **cheese and yogurt making** — industrially important food production.
3. 1 mark **Yeast fermentation** used in wine making and baking industry (CO₂ causes bread to rise).
4. Lactic acid fermentation provides **emergency energy** to muscle cells during vigorous exercise when oxygen supply is insufficient.

SECTION C — Long Questions Answers (5 marks each)

3(i) Define enzyme; five characteristics **5 marks**

Enzyme **1 mark**: Biologically active globular proteins made by living cells which tremendously speed up biochemical reactions — the biological catalysts of cells. Study of enzymes = **enzymology**.

1. Globular proteins: Chains of amino acids folded into 3D globular proteins. Few are RNA — called **ribozymes**.

2. Increase rate of reaction **1 mark**: Millions of times faster than non-enzymatic reactions. Only speed up; do not start reactions. They lower activation energy.

3. Required in small quantity **1 mark**: Enzyme regains original shape after each reaction → reused repeatedly → small quantity catalyses a huge amount of substrate.

4. Specific **1 mark**: Each enzyme catalyses only one reaction on one substrate. Active site has unique shape. Example: **amylase** acts only on starch.

5. Require cofactor **1 mark**: Many enzymes need a non-protein cofactor — activators (Zn^{2+} , Cl^-), prosthetic groups (FAD, Haem), or coenzymes (NAD, Coenzyme A).

Also valid: energy of activation; metabolic pathways; regulation of production and activity.

OR

Three factors affecting enzyme activity (temperature, pH, substrate concentration) **5 marks**

Temperature **1 mark**: Rate rises with temperature to **optimum** (36–38°C for humans). Above optimum: enzyme atoms vibrate → globular structure damaged → **denaturation** (permanent). Below optimum: enzyme inactive (reversible); insufficient activation energy.

pH **1 mark**: Each enzyme has specific **optimum pH**. Change affects ionisation of amino acids at active site. Pepsin: pH 2 (stomach); Trypsin: pH 8 (small intestine). Extreme pH → denaturation.

Substrate concentration **2 marks**: Rate is directly proportional to substrate concentration when enzyme molecules are sufficient. Rate increases until **saturation of active sites** — all sites occupied. Beyond saturation, more substrate has no effect. This plateau is the maximum rate (V_{max}).

Inhibitors & Activators **1 mark**: **Inhibitors** (poisons, cyanide, antibiotics, drugs) reduce/stop enzyme activity.

Activators increase rate. Both regulate enzymes from inside or outside the cell.

3(ii) Mechanism of enzyme action; activation energy; lock-and-key vs induced-fit **5 marks**

Active site **1 mark**: Charge-bearing cavity on enzyme surface — very small, specific shape. Substrate binds here and reaction occurs.

Mechanism — 3 steps **1 mark**: (1) Substrate binds active site → **ES complex**. (2) Enzyme catalyses reaction → **EP complex**. (3) Products released → enzyme unchanged and reusable.

Lowering Activation Energy **1 mark**: Enzyme changes shape/charge of substrate at active site or provides a different reaction mechanism → reactions proceed at body temperature without extreme conditions.

Lock-and-Key Model **1 mark**: Emil Fischer. Active site is **rigid and fixed** (lock); substrate is the specific key. Explains why one enzyme fits only one substrate.

Induced-Fit Model **1 mark**: More accepted. Active site is **flexible**. When the correct substrate approaches, active site **changes shape** to accommodate it precisely. The site is still specific — only the correct substrate can induce the correct conformational change.

OR

Competitive and non-competitive inhibition; allosteric site; daily-life examples **5 marks**

Enzyme inhibition **1 mark**: Chemicals at the reaction site prevent enzymes from performing their role. An inhibitor binds to the enzyme in place of the substrate but does not convert to products. External factors: poisons, cyanide, antibiotics, drugs, accumulated products.

Competitive inhibition **2 marks**: Inhibitor's structure resembles substrate → occupies **active site** → substrate blocked → no product. **Reversible**: excess substrate displaces inhibitor. Example: Sulfonamide drugs competitively inhibit bacterial enzyme needed for folic acid synthesis → kills bacteria (antibiotic action).

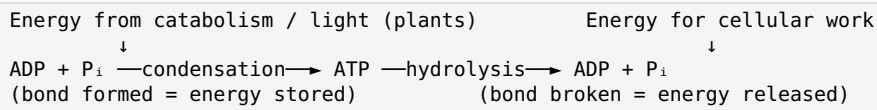
Non-competitive inhibition **2 marks**: Inhibitor does not resemble substrate → binds to **allosteric site** (enzyme surface, not active site) → alters globular shape → active site damaged → substrate cannot bind → reaction stops. **Irreversible**. Example: **Cyanide** (rat poison) inhibits cytochrome c oxidase in ETC. Heavy metals (Pb, Hg) can also act as non-competitive inhibitors.

3(iii) ATP as energy currency: structure, ATP-ADP cycle, uses in body 5 marks

ATP as Energy Currency 1 mark: Living organisms use and store energy at cellular level in the form of **Adenosine Triphosphate (ATP)**. Called energy currency because it stores/releases energy like money — converted between forms as needed. Human cells use 100–150 moles of ATP per day.

Structure of ATP 1 mark: Three components: (1) **Adenine** (double-ringed N-base) + (2) **Ribose sugar** (5C pentose) = Adenosine. (3) **Three phosphate groups** (PO₄) in triphosphate chain. Bonds between phosphate groups = **high-energy bonds** (wavy lines). AMP = 1 phosphate; ADP = 2 phosphates; ATP = 3 phosphates.

ATP-ADP Cycle 2 marks:

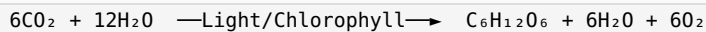


Uses of ATP 1 mark: Working of muscles, nerve impulse transmission, growth and repair of cells, active transport, gland secretion. **Brain** uses maximum ATP — 25% of total body ATP.

OR

Photosynthesis: equation, light-dependent reactions, Calvin cycle in sequence 5 marks

Overall equation 1 mark:



Takes place in plants, algae, cyanobacteria. Chlorophyll absorbs light; CO₂ and H₂O are raw materials; glucose and O₂ are products.

Light-dependent reactions (Phase 1) 2 marks: In **thylakoid membranes** (grana). Starts at **Photosystem II**: (1) Chlorophyll absorbs light → emits electron pair → accepted by primary electron acceptor. (2) **Photolysis of water**: H₂O → O₂ + 2H⁺ + 2e⁻ (O₂ released through stomata). (3) Electrons pass through **ETC** → energy for **ATP synthesis**. (4)

Photosystem I: electrons + 2H⁺ reduce NADP⁺ → **NADPH**. Products: ATP, NADPH, O₂.

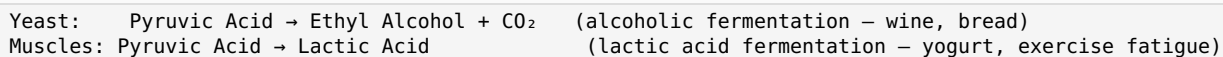
Calvin cycle / Light-independent reactions (Phase 2) 2 marks: In **stroma of chloroplast**. Uses ATP and NADPH from Phase 1. Steps: (1) CO₂ + RuBP (5C) → 6C intermediate → 2 × 3-PGA. (2) 3-PGA reduced by NADPH + ATP → G3P (3C sugar). (3) G3P → glucose synthesis + RuBP regeneration for next cycle. Described by **Melvin Calvin**.

3(iv) Aerobic vs anaerobic respiration; glycolysis; fate of pyruvic acid 5 marks

Feature 1 mark	Aerobic Respiration	Anaerobic Respiration
Oxygen needed	Yes	No
Glucose oxidation	Complete → CO ₂ + H ₂ O	Incomplete → alcohol / lactic acid
ATP yield	36 ATP	2 ATP
Site	Cytoplasm + Mitochondria	Cytoplasm only

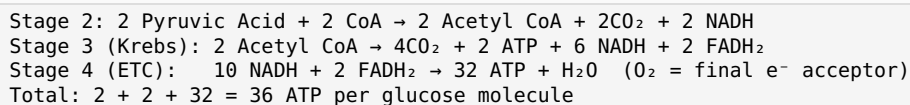
Glycolysis — Common first stage 1 mark: Both pathways start with **glycolysis** in cytoplasm. Glucose (6C) → 2 Pyruvic acid (3C) + 2 ATP + 2 NADH.

Fate in Anaerobic respiration 1 mark: Pyruvic acid not fully oxidised.



Total ATP = only 2 (from glycolysis).

Fate in Aerobic respiration 2 marks: Pyruvic acid enters mitochondria → fully oxidised in 3 further stages:

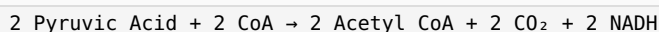


OR

Aerobic respiration: four stages with ATP yield at each 5 marks

Stage 1 — Glycolysis 1 mark: Cytoplasm. Glucose → 2 Pyruvic acid. Net yield: **2 ATP + 2 NADH**. Common to aerobic and anaerobic.

Stage 2 — Formation of Acetyl CoA 1 mark: Mitochondria. Pyruvic acid oxidised; 2C acetyl group + CoA → Acetyl CoA; CO₂ released; NADH produced. Yield: **2 NADH** per glucose.



Stage 3 — Krebs Cycle 1 mark: Mitochondrial matrix. Acetyl group fully oxidised. Yield: **4 CO₂ + 2 ATP + 6 NADH + 2 FADH₂**.

Stage 4 — Electron Transport Chain (ETC) 2 marks: Inner mitochondrial membrane. Electrons from NADH and FADH₂ pass through carrier molecules releasing energy → ATP synthesis. NADH → 3 ATP each; FADH₂ → 2 ATP each. Final electron acceptor = **oxygen** → combines with H⁺ → **water**.

